

Information Security COMP 421

Spring 2025 Section B

Assignment 2 Description

Problem Statement: In this assignment, you will demonstrate your understanding of “Reflected Cross-Site-Scripting” (Reflected XSS), Stealing Cookies, and “Stored Cross-Site-Scripting” (Stored XSS) vulnerabilities in web applications. For doing this assignment, you will install and setup [DVWA](#) platform and perform the assigned tasks.

Installing and setting up DVWA:

```
git clone https://github.com/digininja/DVWA
cd DVWA
sudo apt install apache2 php php-mysqli mariadb-server
sudo cp -r * /var/www/html/
sudo service apache2 start
sudo service mysql start
Configure database via http://localhost/setup.php
Login using default: Username: admin, Password: password
Set up DVWA as per its instructions. Set security level to "Low" for this lab.
```

Task 1 (Reflected XSS Attack):

1. Open your browser and go to: http://localhost/vulnerabilities/xss_r/
2. Enter the following in the input field: `<script>alert('XSS Test')</script>`
3. Click Submit

Note: You should see a popup showing “XSS Test”.

Tasks 2 (Steal Cookie via XSS):

1. Paste the following in the same input field: `<script>document.write(document.cookie)</script>`

Note: The browser displays your current cookie, proving access.

Tasks 3 (Stored XSS Attack):

1. Navigate to: http://localhost/vulnerabilities/xss_s/.
2. Post a comment like: `<script>alert('Stored XSS')</script>`
3. Refresh the page.

Note: Every time the page loads, the alert will trigger — this is a stored attack affecting all users.

Submission Requirements and Deadline:

- You should submit the assignment 1 in a folder “Comp421-RollNumber-Section Name” within the sub folder assignment 1.
- The folder should include a file containing all the screenshots of successfully completing the assigned tasks, and your report in the word file.
- This is an individual assignment. Therefore, you are not allowed to do work in the groups.
- The deadline for the **assignment 2** is **Tuesday 20th May, 2025**.
- The **total marks** for this assignment are **fourteen (14)**.

Grading Criteria

- Screenshots showing successful completion of the tasks: 7 marks.
- Report on observations and lessons learned: 5 marks.
- Submitting the assignment in your git repository: 2 marks.

Note: Any submission after the deadline will be graded with “0”.